

1758. Minimum Changes To Make Alternating Binary String

Difficulty: Easy

Link: <https://leetcode.com/problems/minimum-changes-to-make-alternating-binary-string/description/?envType=daily-question&envId=2026-03-05>

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Problem:

You are given a string `s` consisting only of the characters `'0'` and `'1'`. In one operation, you can change any `'0'` to `'1'` or vice versa.

The string is called alternating if no two adjacent characters are equal. For example, the string `"010"` is alternating, while the string `"0100"` is not.

Return the **minimum** number of operations needed to make `s` alternating.

Example 1:

Input: `s = "0100"`

Output: 1

Explanation: If you change the last character to '1', `s` will be `"0101"`, which is alternating.

Example 2:

Input: `s = "10"`

Output: 0

Explanation: `s` is already alternating.

Example 3:

Input: `s = "1111"`

Output: 2

Explanation: You need two operations to reach "0101" or "1010".

Constraints:

- $1 \leq s.length \leq 10^4$
- `s[i]` is either `'0'` or `'1'`.